GLOBAL MENTORSHIP INITIATIVE

# Cover Letter Guide

## How to create a professional cover letter




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# Cover Letters

## What is a Cover Letter?

A cover letter is a one-page document submitted along with your resume or CV for a job application. Cover letters consist of a short overview of your professional experience, skills, and education that are most relevant to the job posting.

## Why Cover Letters are Necessary

Cover letters provide candidates the opportunity to introduce themselves to the recruiter or hiring manager and showcase the specific skills and qualifications they possess that align with the job description. The purpose of a cover letter is to convince the recruiter or hiring manager to read your resume and consider your application for the position.

You should always include a cover letter when submitting a resume or CV. The only time you should not submit a cover letter is if the online job application specifically states a cover letter is not necessary or does not allow for submitting a cover letter online.

## Cover Letter Checklist

- ✓ **Customize** - create a new cover letter and modify it for each individual job you are applying for.
- ✓ **Keywords** - use keywords found in the 'Requirements' and 'Qualifications' sections of the job description when describing the skills gained from your professional experience.
- ✓ **Proofread** - check for spelling errors, proper grammar, and field-specific terminology.
- ✓ **Peer Review** - reach out to colleagues in your field and other professional contacts to request they read your cover letter to identify errors and suggest changes.
- ✓ **Be Imaginative** - think outside of the box; start your cover letter with something interesting and thoughtful that will catch the reader's eye and help them remember you.
- ✓ **Culture** - as you write, keep in mind the culture of the company you are applying for and who will be reading your cover letter.

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# Basic Components of a Cover Letter

**Header**
Your header should be in the same style as the header on your resume or curriculum vitae (CV) and include your full name as it appears on your resume or CV and LinkedIn profile, mobile phone number with the country code if applying to an international position or company, professional email address (firstname.lastname@gmail.com), and LinkedIn profile web address.

The full date, including month, day, and year, you plan to submit your resume and cover letter.

Company Contact Information: The recruiter or hiring manager's name and title, company's name, department or program name if provided, and physical address.

**Greeting**
A professional, formal greeting to the recruiter or hiring manager, or a general greeting to the director, employer, or hiring committee.

**Body Paragraphs**
**Introduction: 2-3 sentences that state the position you are applying for, how you became aware of the job listing, and the name and title of a current employee who referred you to the position if available. A compelling hook that shows enthusiasm for role.**
1-2 paragraphs that detail specifically why you are a good fit for the position, as well as the company overall.

**Closing Paragraph**
2-3 sentences with a confident wrap up and reminder why you are good fit. Thank the recruiter or hiring manager for taking the time to consider your application for the position, express your interest in meeting with them in person to discuss your qualifications further, and the best phone number or email address for them to contact you.

**Salutation**
A professional end to your cover letter with your full name (as it appears on your header) written below.

- **Remember, the longer the cover letter, the less likely the recruiter or hiring manager is to read the entire letter and**
- **move on to your resume.**

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# AI Questions and Resources

## AI Questions for Cover Letters

✓Write a cover letter for this job.  Below is the job description and my resume/CV.

## Resources for Cover Letters

'Are Cover Letters Necessary in 2026?' – Coursera Staff
https://www.coursera.org/articles/are-cover-letters-necessary

'How to Write a Cover Letter' – Michael Tomaszewsky with Zety
https://zety.com/blog/how-to-write-a-cover-letter

'How to Show Your Personality in a Cover Letter' – Alison Doyle with The Balance Career
https://www.thebalancecareers.com/how-to-show-your-personality-in-a-cover-letter-4174695

'If a Job Doesn't Ask for a Cover Letter, Should I Send One Anyway?' – Vicki Salemi with Monster
https://www.monster.com/career-advice/article/cover-letter-job-ad-ask-vicki-quora-0617

'Tricky Cover Letter Mistakes to Avoid' – Kim Isaacs with Monster
https://www.monster.com/career-advice/article/cover-letter-mistakes-0417

'How to Write a Cover Letter for a Job' – Coursera Staff
https://www.coursera.org/articles/how-to-write-a-cover-letter

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